

Sand Technologies

"Physical AI" operating system for critical infrastructure — water, energy, telecom, health & government · sandtech.com

2023 Founded	~500–680 Employees	18+ Countries deployed	12+ Named clients (public)	\$15–67M Est. revenue (3rd-party)	3.6 / 5 Glassdoor (47)	B– Simplify rating
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01 Company Snapshot

Product: Symmetri — a real-time “Physical AI” control layer that models physical assets/networks and acts on them (vs. dashboards/analytics alone). Applied across water, energy, telecom, health and government operations. Footprint: Engineering & delivery across Silicon Valley, Paris, Romania, Latin America and Africa; registered HQ entity in Mauritius; opened a formal U.S. commercial presence with a New York launch event, June 2025. Lineage: Grew out of a decade-plus of AI/data consulting work; merged with ExploreAI (Feb 2024); heritage entity distinct from the unrelated 1980s-founded “SAND Technology” (Canada, columnar database). Leadership: Founder/CEO Fred Swaniker — Stanford MBA, ex-McKinsey; also founder of African Leadership Group / ALX (talent pipeline of 300,000+ trained professionals feeding Sand's hiring). TIME 100 (2019, 2023 Impact Award), WEF Young Global Leader, TED Fellow.	Selected clients & partners AWS (Advanced Tier partner) · GE · JP Morgan · Thames Water (UK) · Telkomsel (Indonesia) · Envision Racing / Formula E · Cassava Technologies (GPU-as-a-service MoU) · Compass UOL Ownership / funding Backed in part by the Bestseller Foundation; total funding not publicly disclosed (PitchBook lists no reported round). Structured largely as a project/subscription services business, not VC-metric SaaS. Web: Link · LinkedIn Key people: Fred Swaniker (Founder & CEO) · Danai Mavunga (COO) · David Bratt (CFO)
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02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

All impact figures below are vendor- or partner-reported and have not been independently audited.

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Water utilities	Thames Water (UK) — predictive network management	Vendor describes moving the utility from reactive to predictive management; no standalone quantified result published	Link
Telecom	Telkomsel (Indonesia) network optimization; AWS Marketplace “AI-Driven Network Planner” (Bedrock + SageMaker) for site investment	+8–15% data traffic, +5–8% coverage, \$10–50M annual value at Telkomsel — without new infrastructure	Link
Health	Rural clinic network, Africa	Connects thousands of rural clinics into one coordinated-care network serving millions of patients	Link
Disaster response	Post-tornado city response — Symmetri damage-assessment layer	~5,400 damaged structures mapped, ~\$0.8B in estimated losses prioritized for recovery resources	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Direct — industrial / physical-AI platforms Palantir (Foundry / Gotham / AIP) · C3.ai · Cognite · IBM watsonx · Bentley Systems (iTwin / AssetWise) · AVEVA · Honeywell Forge · Siemens Xcelerator	Adjacent Global IT-services / AI consultancies (Globant, Endava) and Africa talent-to-tech delivery peers (Andela) compete for the same services budget, if not the same platform category.
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Positioning: Sand markets a new “Physical AI” category — sensing, modeling and directly acting on infrastructure, vs. dashboards/analytics. Palantir and C3.ai are the closest comparables by ambition; Cognite, Bentley and AVEVA are closer on the digital-twin angle. Sand's edge is emerging-market delivery reach (ALX talent pipeline, Cassava GPU access); its risk is being a smaller, services-heavy player among better-capitalized platform vendors — echoed in its own C differentiation score above.

04 Sentiment

Customer: No independent review presence: Sand Symmetri's AWS Marketplace listing shows zero submitted reviews, and there is no active G2/Capterra/TrustRadius profile. What exists is vendor-published case studies with metrics but no verbatim customer quotes.

What supports the story	What to pressure-test
• High-profile founder (TIME 100, WEF Young Global Leader, TED Fellow) drives press and government access; Aug 2026 “Evolve” summit drew 300+ leaders • AWS Advanced Tier partner status + Compass UOL partnership broaden enterprise channel reach • Warm public reception at 2025 U.S. launch, incl. on-record praise from NYC's CTO • Deployments claimed across 18+ countries with “zero mission-critical failures” (vendor claim, unaudited)	• Headcount down ~6% (6-mo) / ~9% (2-yr) per Simplify tracking, despite a growth narrative • Revenue concentration in large infrastructure clients, which creates project-delay risk if deployments slip • Cassava GPU-access agreement is a non-binding MoU; employee reviews cite frequent strategy pivots and an “unclear product offering” • Analyst-rated C on Differentiation — crowded field vs. Palantir, C3.ai, Cognite, Bentley, AVEVA

Employee: Praise for mission, talent and pace of delivery; recurring complaints about frequent strategic pivots, an unclear product offering, and meeting load.

Sources: sandtech.com · Glassdoor · Simplify.jobs · PitchBook & Crunchbase · AWS Marketplace listing (AI-Driven Network Planner) · FF News / Hypertext / EA Business Times (Cassava MoU, May 2025) · Wikipedia (Fred Swaniker) · IoT For All, ZoomInfo & BuiltIn. Figures are vendor/partner-reported as of Sept. 2026, not independently verified.